



CUSTOMER SUCCESS PLAYBOOK

A practical framework for turning customers into long-term partners, advocates and growth.



Technology does not build customer loyalty. Relationships do.

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The Customer Success Operating Model

From purchase to measurable business outcomes



Accelerate Value

Reduce time-to-value and create early confidence.



Drive Adoption

Move usage toward meaningful business outcomes.



Protect Revenue

Identify risk early and strengthen retention.



Create Growth

Expand through earned trust and customer value.

THE 8-STAGE CUSTOMER LIFECYCLE



THE CORE QUESTION

“Is the customer achieving the outcome they bought us to achieve?”

Every lifecycle activity should connect back to customer value, trust and measurable outcomes.

Stage 1 - Handover & Success Planning

The customer journey starts before the first CSM meeting

HANDOVER CHECKLIST

- ✓ Business objectives
- ✓ Commercial agreement
- ✓ Key stakeholders
- ✓ Primary use case
- ✓ Success criteria
- ✓ Implementation needs
- ✓ Sales commitments
- ✓ Known risks
- ✓ Growth potential

CUSTOMER SUCCESS PLAN

- | | |
|-----------|----------------------------------|
| OBJECTIVE | What are they trying to achieve? |
| METRIC | How will success be measured? |
| MILESTONE | What must happen next? |
| OWNER | Who owns each action? |
| RISK | What could prevent success? |

Before meeting the customer, the CSM should be able to answer:

1

Why did they buy?

2

What outcome do they expect?

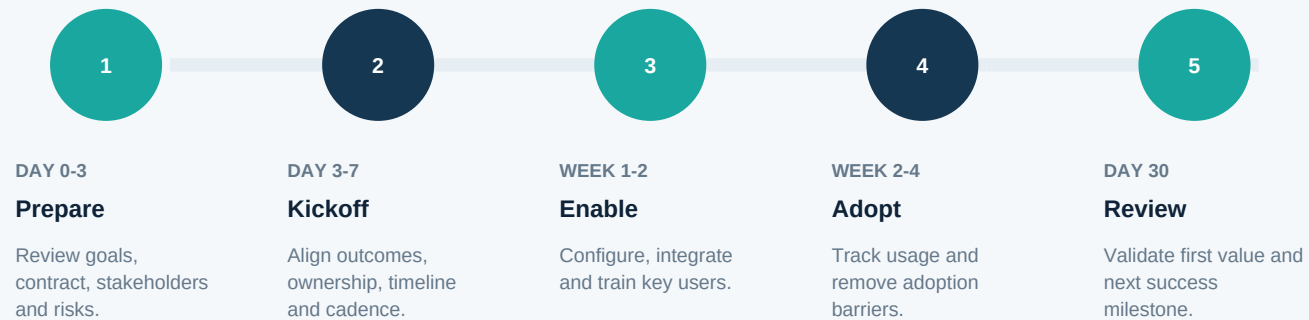
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What could prevent success?

Stage 2 - Onboarding & Time-to-Value

Move customers from purchase to confidence

30-DAY ONBOARDING ROADMAP



TIME-TO-VALUE



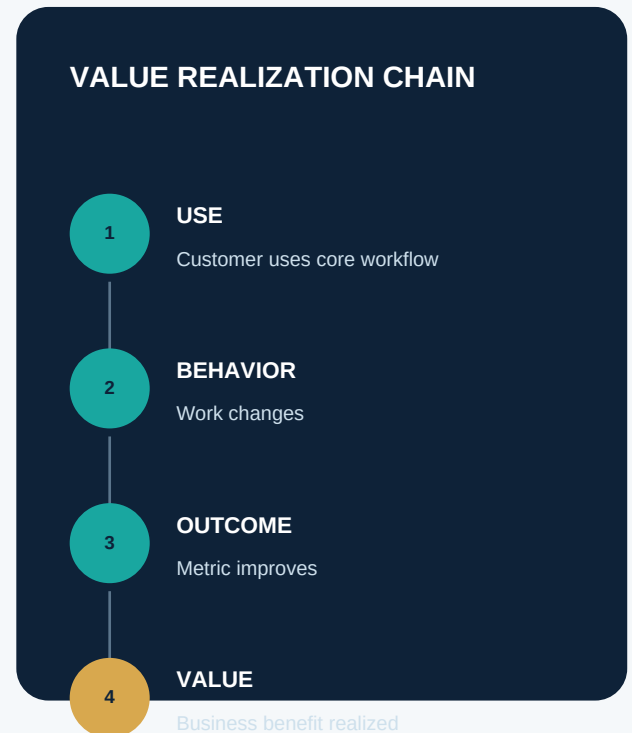
ONBOARDING SUCCESS =

- Right stakeholders engaged
- Users enabled
- Core workflow activated
- First measurable value achieved
- Next success milestone agreed

Stage 3 - Adoption & Value Realization

Usage matters only when it creates customer outcomes

ADOPTION MATRIX

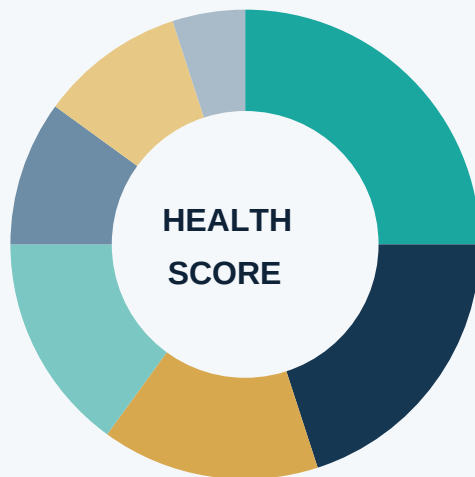


ADOPTION SIGNALS TO MONITOR

- Active users
- Login frequency
- Feature adoption
- Workflow completion
- Transaction volume
- Training completion
- License utilization
- Support dependency

Customer Health Score

Combine data signals with human judgment



	Product Adoption	25%
	Business Outcomes	20%
	Engagement	15%
	Relationship Strength	15%
	Support Experience	10%
	Sentiment	10%
	Commercial Status	5%



GREEN

Healthy

Strong adoption, value and engagement.



AMBER

Attention

Declining signals or unclear value.



RED

High Risk

Dissatisfaction, churn indicators or commercial risk.

Principle: Dashboards identify signals. CSM judgment interprets what those signals mean.

Proactive Engagement & QBRs

Make every customer interaction earn its place on the calendar

Operational

Implementation, actions, blockers

Strategic

Outcomes, priorities, recommendations

Executive

ROI, risk, partnership, future

QBR: FROM REPORTING TO STRATEGIC VALUE

1

Executive Summary

2

Objectives Reviewed

3

Outcomes Achieved

4

Adoption Insights

5

Risks & Challenges

6

Recommendations

7

Strategic Alignment

8

Next-Quarter Plan

QBR QUESTION

What value has the customer achieved - and what should we accomplish next?

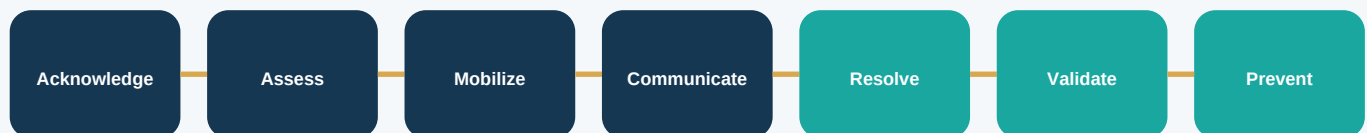
Risk & Escalation Management

Detect early. Own clearly. Communicate consistently.

COMMON CHURN SIGNALS

- Usage decline
- Unresolved issues
- Meeting disengagement
- Budget pressure
- Repeated escalations
- Champion leaves
- Negative sentiment
- No measurable ROI
- Competitor evaluation
- Contract disputes

ESCALATION FLOW



HIGH-RISK ACCOUNT PLAN

- Risk description
- Business impact
- Recovery actions
- Root cause
- Owner
- Target date

COMMUNICATION RULE

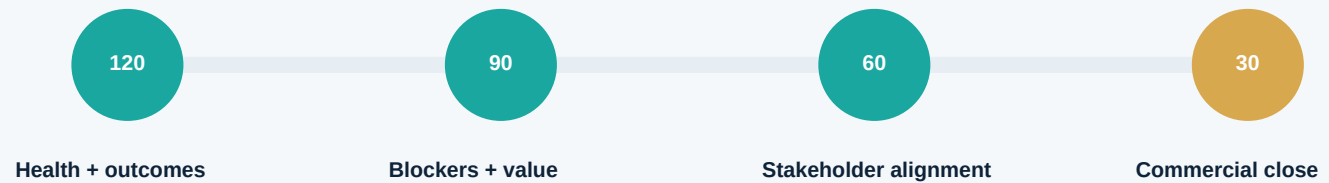
Silence increases customer anxiety.

Even without a final fix, customers should know who owns the issue, what is happening and when the next update will come.

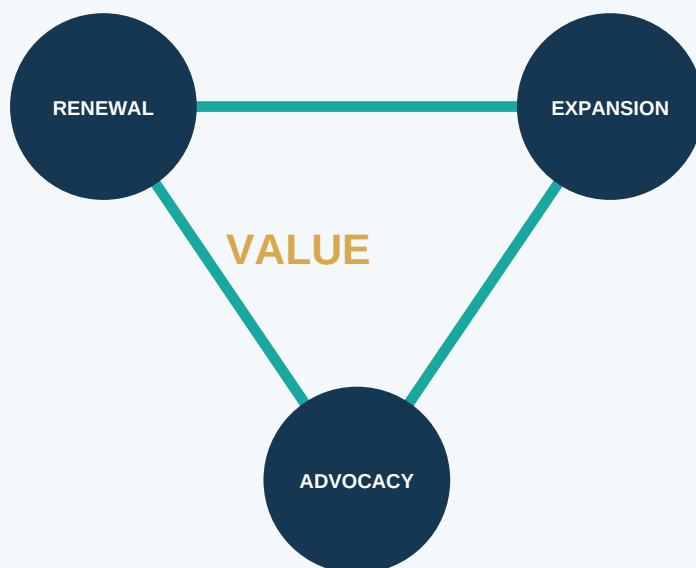
Renewal, Expansion & Advocacy

Commercial outcomes should be the result of customer value

120-DAY RENEWAL RUNWAY



GROWTH FLYWHEEL



EXPANSION SIGNALS

- Increasing usage
- New teams request access
- High license utilization
- New business units
- New strategic priorities
- Positive executive engagement
- Requests for more capability
- Strong ROI realization

Customer Success KPI Framework

Measure customer value, retention, efficiency and growth

RETENTION

- GRR
- NRR
- Customer Retention
- Churn Rate

EXPERIENCE

- CSAT
- NPS
- Customer Effort
- Escalation Rate

OPERATIONS

- Time-to-Value
- Onboarding Completion
- Adoption
- QBR Completion

GROWTH

- Expansion Revenue
- Upsell Rate
- Cross-sell Rate
- Referrals

LEADERSHIP VIEW

Retention



86%

Adoption



72%

Health



78%

Expansion

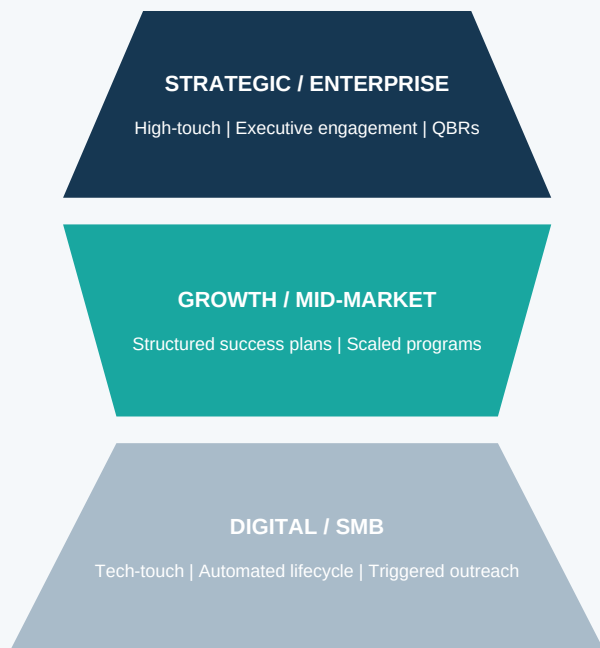


61%

Segmentation & Operating Rhythm

Match service intensity to customer value, complexity and risk

CUSTOMER SEGMENTATION



OPERATING RHYTHM

DAILY

Critical escalations • High-risk actions

WEEKLY

Health • Risk • Onboarding • Renewals

MONTHLY

Portfolio • Churn • Adoption • Coaching

QUARTERLY

Strategic reviews • KPI • VoC • Process

RESOURCE ALLOCATION PRINCIPLE

Segmentation should consider more than contract value.

Complexity, strategic importance, risk, support needs and growth potential should influence the customer success model.

The CSM 6-Dimension Account View

A simple executive lens for every strategic customer



FINAL PRINCIPLE

Customer Success is a growth engine when customers adopt, achieve value, stay, grow and advocate.

Technology supports the relationship. Data provides direction. Operational discipline creates consistency. Trust turns customers into long-term partners.

CUSTOMER SUCCESS

is measured by outcomes.

- ✓ Do customers adopt?
- ✓ Do customers achieve value?
- ✓ Do customers stay?
- ✓ Do customers grow?
- ✓ Do customers advocate?

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“Technology does not build customer loyalty. Relationships do.”

Designed as a practical portfolio framework for modern Customer Success teams.